question is: Should the word of a person, however reliable, be taken as a proof for purposes of knowledge? In India, we see no harm or logical error in it; and consequently, we do not hesitate to take on trust the testimony of other persons with regard to all those experiences to which, we ordinary human beings have no access either through direct perception or through reasoning. And it is hardly an exaggeration to say that almost all our so-called philosophical tenets, such as the spiritual nature of the universe, the moral law of *dharma,* the theory of rebirth *(mokṣa),* are more in the nature of beliefs taken on trust on the strength of the unimpeachability of the character of their testifiers than in the nature of proved conclusions arrived at by philosophical arguments. The same, however, is done in the Western world in the realm of higher truths of the sciences. More than nine-tenths of our knowledge of the physical, the chemical, or the medical world consist of our acceptance of the knowledge and assertions of the few experts who alone have any direct access to the validity of their truths. But, somehow, when it comes to the super-sensible, the modern Western mind reacts differently. That, however, is not to say that such religious or intuitional experiences or truths are, therefore, valid. The fact remains that the so-called fundamental tenets of Indian philosophy are mostly grounded in testimony of the seers, or the *ṛṣis,* or of the realized souls, though the average man or even a trained thinker may have no inkling of them by pure reasoning or abstract logic. The total impression left on the mind of a modern thinker about the fundamental beliefs of Indian thought is that they all lack philosophical basis and that they can hardly be called philosophical, unless the very meaning of what the Indians call "philosophical activity" is changed.

To sum up, I have tried to think of the fundamental tenets of Indian philosophy, and in so doing, I have been compelled to maintain that, strictly and philosophically speaking, no such basic tenets can be found in the long history of our philosophical thought. Even a comparison of Indian philosophical thought with Western philosophy does not reveal any such principle or truth which could be termed peculiarly Indian. Next, I examined the fundamental tenets which are commonly regarded in India as well as outside of India as the basic tenets of Indian philosophy and found no justification for calling them philosophy proper or as being founded on philosophical arguments and reasoning alone. Nevertheless, most of these truths, particularly those about the transmigration of the soul, or of the nature of *mokṣa,* and the Law of Karma remain peculiarly Indian and also fundamental to our